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DAILY PRACTICE PAPER-08/05/2026:

1. Who among the following Governor-Generals of India is associated with the abolition of the Sati system?

- A) Lord Dalhousie
- B) Lord William Bentinck
- C) Lord Cornwallis
- D) Lord Wellesley

Answer: B) Lord William Bentinck

Explanation: The Bengal Sati Regulation, which banned the Sati practice in all jurisdictions of British India, was passed on December 4, 1829. This landmark social reform was enacted by the then Governor-General Lord William Bentinck.

2. Which river is famously known as the "Sorrow of Bihar"?

- A) Ganga
- B) Yamuna
- C) Kosi
- D) Son

Answer: C) Kosi Explanation: The Kosi River is known as the "Sorrow of Bihar" because of its tendency to frequently change its course. The

heavy silt it carries during the monsoon blocks its natural flow, causing it to breach its banks and trigger massive, devastating floods across the state.

3. The languages recognized by the Indian Constitution are listed in which Schedule?

- A) Sixth Schedule
- B) Seventh Schedule
- C) Eighth Schedule
- D) Ninth Schedule

Answer: C) Eighth Schedule

Explanation: The Eighth Schedule to the Constitution of India lists the official languages of the Republic of India. While the Constitution originally recognized 14 languages, subsequent amendments have increased the number to 22 recognized languages today.

4. What is the common name of the chemical compound Sodium Bicarbonate?

- A) Washing Soda
- B) Baking Soda
- C) Bleaching Powder
- D) Plaster of Paris

Answer: B) Baking Soda Explanation:

Sodium bicarbonate is commonly known as baking soda. It is primarily used in cooking and baking as a leavening agent because it reacts with acids to release carbon dioxide gas, causing batter to rise. Washing soda is sodium carbonate, and bleaching powder is calcium hypochlorite.

5. The concept of Five-Year Plans in the Indian economic system was borrowed from which of the following nations?

- A) USA
- B) UK
- C) USSR
- D) France

Answer: C) USSR Explanation: After independence, India adopted a model of centralized economic planning. The concept of creating Five-Year Plans to guide the country's economic development was heavily inspired by the planning models utilized in the former Soviet Union (USSR). India's first Five-Year Plan was launched in 1951.

6. The vibrant "Hornbill Festival" is predominantly celebrated in which Indian state?

- A) Manipur
- B) Nagaland
- C) Sikkim
- D) Meghalaya

Answer: B) Nagaland Explanation:

The Hornbill Festival is a massive annual festival celebrated from December 1 to 10 in Nagaland. Organized by the State Tourism and Art & Culture Departments, it is known as the "Festival of Festivals" and showcases the rich cultural heritage, dances, and traditions of the various Naga tribes.

7. Which of the following vitamins is water-soluble?

- A) Vitamin A
- B) Vitamin C
- C) Vitamin D
- D) Vitamin K

Answer: B) Vitamin C Explanation: Vitamins B and C are water-soluble vitamins, meaning they dissolve in water and are not stored in the body in large amounts; any excess is excreted. In contrast, Vitamins A, D, E, and K are fat-soluble and are stored in the body's fatty tissue and liver.

8. In which year was the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) nationalized?

- A) 1935
- B) 1947
- C) 1949
- D) 1951

Answer: C) 1949 Explanation: While the Reserve Bank of India was initially established on April 1, 1935, as a private entity, it was nationalized shortly after India's independence on January 1, 1949. Since that date, it has been fully owned and operated by the Government of India.

9. The Tropic of Cancer does NOT pass through which of the following Indian states?

- A) Gujarat
- B) Tripura
- C) Madhya Pradesh
- D) Odisha

Answer: D) Odisha Explanation: The Tropic of Cancer (23.5 degrees North latitude) passes almost halfway through India, crossing exactly eight states:

Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Tripura, and Mizoram. It lies slightly north of Odisha.

10. Who is the author of the ancient Indian collection of interrelated animal fables known as 'Panchatantra'?

- A) Kalidasa
- B) Vishnu Sharma
- C) Banabhatta
- D) Tulsidas

Answer: B) Vishnu Sharma Explanation: The 'Panchatantra' is an ancient Indian text compiling educational and moral stories, primarily featuring animals as characters. It is widely believed to have been composed in Sanskrit by the scholar Vishnu Sharma to teach political science and practical wisdom to three young princes.